



C QUICK REFERENCE GUIDE

Authorized Resource for CS210

Version 23

Useful Header Files (add using the '#include <library>' directive)

stdio.h - input/output (printf, scanf)
 math.h - math functions (use -lm to compile)
 stdbool.h - defines bool data type
 string.h - string comparison functions (see back)

- #include <stdio.h> Loading a standard library
- #include "myfile.h" Loading a library you wrote (must be in same folder)

gcc Compilation

Simple/Batch Compilation

Use this to compile your c files all at once.

```
gcc program.c -Wall -Werror -o program
```

File(s) to compile Error on warnings Output file (a.out if missing)

Separate Compilation

Use this method when your program consists of multiple *.c files

```
gcc program.c -Wall -Werror -c      produces program.o
gcc file1.c -Wall -Werror -c      produces file1.o
gcc program.o file1.o prog      links *.o files → prog
```

Main Program

Lesson 1

Every C program has exactly one **main()** function. It is the first thing that runs when you start the program.

```
1 #include <stdio.h>
2
3 // This main will return an int when done
4 int main() {
5
6     // Prints 'hello world' and a new line
7     printf("Hello World\n");
8
9     // Returns an integer (see line 4)
10    return 0;
11 }
```

printf() - print formatted, in the stdio.h library

Lessons 2/3

The printf() function lets you output text/values/variables to the screen.

```
printf("Welcome to CS210");      // Text Only
>> Welcome to CS210

printf("%d %f", 5, x);      // Values and Variables
>> 5 1.23      (x = 1.23)

printf("%d is my favorite number", 5);      // Text and values
>> 5 is my favorite number

printf("%08.5f", 1.234567890);      // Formatting Numbers
>> 01.23457      (8 chars, 5 dec, leading 0s)

\n = New Line    \t = Tab    \ = '\\' character
```

Casting

```
float myValue = (float)1/(float)2; // converts 1, 2 to floats
```

Format Specifiers

Lessons 2-4

See <http://www.cplusplus.com/reference/cstdio/printf/>

Data Type	character
int (32-bit single precision integer)	%d or %i
unsigned int	%u
long (64-bit double precision integer)	%li
float (32-bit single precision real #)	%f
double (64-bit double precision real #)	%lf
char (a single letter)	%c
scientific notation	%e
pointer address	%p

scanf() - scan formatted; in the stdio.h library

Lesson 3

The scanf() function lets you get one or more values from the user. It does not print a prompt!

```
// Make sure you declare your variables before using scanf!
int intVar = 0;
float floatVar = 0.0;
double doubleVar = 0.0;
char charVar = '';

// Various ways to get one or more values from the user
scanf("%d", &intVar);      // int
scanf("%d%f", &intVar, &floatVar);      // int & float (ex: 1 2.34)
scanf("%c", &charVar);      // 1 letter
scanf(" %c", &charVar);      // removes leading spaces
```

Variable Declaration

General Syntax

```
type var = value;
int numBunnies = 5;
float miles = 26.3;
```

Variables must start with letters, but can contain numbers and underscores.
Variable names are case sensitive

Variable Assignment

Stored In

```
variable = exp/value;
x = 1;
var = a + b + 23;

// Shortcuts
x++;      // adds one
x+=2;      // adds two
```

.h and .c files

.h files contain function declarations. This is the file you #include in your programs! NOTE: a .h file typically has a matching .c

```
#ifndef MYFUNCTS_H
#define MYFUNCTS_H

// Function declarations
int add(int num1, int num2);
int sub(int num1, int num2);

#endif
```

.c files contain definitions (i.e. code) for each .h function

```
myfuncts.c
// See how add() matches .h file
int add(int num1, int num2) {
    return num1 + num2;
}
```

Functions

Functions let us define reusable chunks of code. Each function performs a single task.

Specifies what this function will return (void if nothing)

```
Function Name      Parameters (The Info the Function Needs)

float functionName(type parameter 1, type parameter2, ...) {
    // Your code goes here
    return value;
}
```

Return Value
This is what the function "gives back" to the caller
Functions immediately end once they return a value

Calling Functions

Functions do not run by themselves. You must call them from other functions (i.e., main)

```
// Defining the function
float areaRectangle(float width, float height) {
    return width * height;
}

// Calling the function
float w = 10.0
float h = 5.0
float area = areaRectangle(w, h);
```

The argument name does not have to match the parameter!

Conditional Logic

Lesson 7

```
if (LOGICAL TEST(S)) {
    DO WHEN ABOVE IS TRUE
}
else if (LOGICAL TEST(S)) {
    DO WHEN ABOVE IS TRUE
}
else {
    DO IF NOTHING IS TRUE
}
```

Repeat as Needed

Required

Optional

Only the first TRUE block of code will execute.

Relational Operator	Symbol	Example
Equal To	==	name == 'bob'
Not Equal To	!=	x != 5
Greater Than	>	2023 > 2006
Greater Than or Equal To	>=	gpa >= 2.0
Less Than	<	21 < your_age
Less Than or Equal To	<=	x

Logical Operator	Description	Example
&&	True if BOTH conditions are True	GPA >= 3.0 && GPA <= 4.0
	True if either condition is True	GPA < 2.0 PEA < 2.0 MPA < 2.0
!	True if the condition is not True	!(GPA < 2.0)

```
// Declaring/printing bool variables
bool isSunny = true;
printf("isSunny is %d", isSunny);
```

Characters / Strings Lesson 9, 10

A **character** is a single letter. It is denoted with single ticks

```
// Declaring a single character (NOT a string)
char letter = 'u';

// Getting a char using scanf
scanf("%c", &letter); & is required!
```

A **string** is an array of characters. It is denoted w/double quotes

```
// String of (max) 50 characters
```

```
char myString[50] = "CS210";
```

HOW myString IS REPRESENTED IN MEMORY

chars	C	S	2	1	0	\0				
index	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	...

Null Terminator

```
// Getting a single word (e.g., "hi")
```

```
char myString[50];
```

```
scanf("%s", myString); Do not put an &
```

```
// Getting multiple words (e.g., "hello world")
```

```
// Requires <string.h>
```

```
fgets(myString, 50, stdin);
```

Max Size Input

String Functions – Included with <string.h> Lesson 9

// Declaring Variables

```
char string1[50] = "brown";
```

```
char string2[50] = "bear";
```

```
int result = 0;
```

// You cannot assign strings after declaration

```
string1 = "hello"; // not assignable
```

// Use strncpy instead!

```
strncpy(string1, "hello", 5); // works!
```

Due to security risks, it is best practice to use the green versions of each function.

```
// Gets the length of string1
```

```
result = strlen(string1); // returns 5
```

```
result = strlen(string1, 3); // returns 3 since 3 is specified as max
```

```
// String Comparisons (returns ASCII difference of char that differs)
```

```
result = strcmp(string1, string1); // returns 0 since they are equal
```

```
result = strcmp(string1, string2); // returns 13 since r > e
```

```
result = strcmp(string2, string1); // returns -13 since e > r
```

```
result = strncmp(string2, string1, 1); // returns 0 since b == b
```

```
// String Copying
```

```
strcpy(string1, string2); // copies string2 into string1 (adds '\0')
```

```
strncpy(string1, string2, 3); // copy first 3 chars of string2 to string1
```

```
// String Concatenation ("abc" + "def" = "abcdef")
```

```
strcat(string1, string2); // copies string2 to the end of string1
```

```
strncat(string1, string2, 3); // copies n chars of string2 to string1
```

Switch Statement Lesson 11

Switch statements let a variable / value be tested for equality against a list of values.

```
switch (variable) {
```

```
case 'A':
```

```
DO WHEN variable == 'A'
```

```
break; ← The break is needed to exit
```

```
case 'B': the switch
```

```
DO WHEN variable == 'B'
```

```
break;
```

```
default: ← Do this if nothing above matches
```

```
DO WHEN variable != A or B
```

```
}
```

Loops / Iteration Lesson 12

For Loop

Repeats a predetermined number of times. Useful when you know in advance how many times the loop needs to execute.

Ex) Counting from 0-9, OR Repeating 10x

```
for (int i = 0; i < 10; i++) {
    // The code you want to execute
    // ten times goes here
}
```

Declare / Initialize Control Variable (i) Exit when False How to Modify i After Each Iteration

While (or Do-While) Loop Lesson 12/13

Continues executing the same sequence of code as long as the test condition evaluates to **True**.

Ex) Counting from 0-9

```
// Initialize the loop control variable
int i = 0;
```

```
// Test the loop control variable (x < 10) {
```

```
# Code Goes Here
```

```
i = i + 1;
```

```
}
```

While loop will run 0 or more times

```
// Initialize the loop control variable
int i = 0;
```

```
// Test the loop control variable (x < 10) {
```

```
# Code Goes Here
```

```
i = i + 1;
```

```
} while (x < 10);
```

Do-while loop will run 1 or more times

Pointers Lesson 14

Pointers are variables that store memory addresses

```
// Creating an integer pointer
int* p = NULL;
```

p □ p is pointing at nothing

```
// Pointing p at an integer
```

```
int value = 2024;
```

```
p = &value;
```

p □ value 2024
p now contains value's address

```
// Modify the value stored at p
```

```
*p = 2006
```

p □ value 2006
*p = "the value contained at the memory address"

```
// Printing p's address/value
```

```
printf("Addr:%p, value:%d, p:%d", p, value, *p);
```

```
>> Addr:0x<address>, value:2006, *p:2006
```

Use **pointers** to return multiple values from a function

```
// Defining the function
```

```
float swap(int* a, int* b) { // a and b are pointers
```

```
int temp = *a;
```

```
*a = *b; // saves a's value
```

```
*b = temp; // swaps a's value with b's
```

```
return *a; // sets b's value with a's
```

```
// Calling the function
```

```
int value1 = 10;
```

```
int value2 = 20;
```

```
swap(&value1, &value2); // Declaring 2 int variables
```

```
// Passing the address of value1 and value2 to swap
```

Arrays Lesson 15-16

An **array** is a set of indexed variables that share a common name.

One-Dimensional Arrays

```
int pft_scores[5] = {141, 300, 450, 500, 251};
```

This array is logically equivalent to:

index	0	1	2	3	4
values	141	300	450	500	251

```
// Create an Empty Array w/4 values
```

```
int my_array[4];
```

```
// Getting a Single Value by Index
```

```
my_array[0];
```

```
// Create an Array with Values
```

```
// Note the []
```

```
char another_array[] = {'a', 'i'};
```

```
// Prints Each Cell in the Array
```

```
for (int i = 0; i < 5; i++) {
```

```
    print("%d ", pft_scores[i];
```

```
}
```

```
// Function declaration w/array param
```

```
void my_function(int array[], int size);
```

No number needed Size/length of array

Two-Dimensional Array

A two-dimensional array is basically a table

```
int myArray[3][2] = {{1, 123},
                     {2, 234},
                     {3, 345}};
```

Rows # Cols

myArray is logically equivalent to:

	Column 0	Column 1
Row 0	1	123
Row 1	2	234
Row 2	3	345
Row 3	4	456

```
// Accessing a Specific Cell
```

```
myArray[row][column];
```

```
// Prints Each Row of the Array
```

```
for (int r=0; r < 4; r++){ // rows
```

```
    for (int c=0; c < 2; c++){ // cols
```

```
        printf("%d ", myArray[r][c]);
```

```
    } printf("\n"); // done printing a row
```

```
}
```

```
// Function declaration w/2D array param
```

```
void my_function(int array[R][C]);
```

Optional (can be []) Required

Enumerated Types Lesson 17

Enum are user-defined types with user-defined values

(C treats enum values as integers)

```
// Creating an enum for weekdays
```

```
// Unless specified, Mon=0, Tues=1, etc.
```

```
enum Weekday {Mon, Tues, Wed, Thur, Fri};
```

```
// Creating a variable of type Weekday
```

```
enum Weekday today = Mon;
```

```
// Printing an enum variable as an int
```

```
printf("%i", today); // will print 0
```

fscanf & fprintf Lesson 19

Lets you specify the source/destination for scanning/printing.

```
// Using fprintf
```

```
// stdout = Monitor
```

```
char str[100];
```

```
fprintf(stdout, "%s", str);
```

```
// Using fscanf
```

```
// stdin = Keyboard
```

```
fscanf(stdin, "%s", str);
```

Ctype – Included with <ctype.h> Lesson 20

Lets you analyze characters and alter their values.

Ex) char c = 'a';

```
// Check if Letter
```

```
if (isalpha(c)) {
```

```
    // c is a letter
```

```
}
```

```
// Check if Number
```

```
if (isdigit(c)) {
```

```
    // c is 0-9
```

```
}
```

```
// Check if Upper Case
```

```
if (isupper(c)) {
```

```
    // c is upper case
```

```
}
```

```
// Check if Lower Case
```

```
if (islower(c)) {
```

```
    // c is lower case
```

```
}
```

```
// To Lower Case
```

```
c = tolower(c);
```

```
// To Upper Case
```

```
c = toupper(c);
```

```
// Create a File Pointer
FILE* file = NULL;

// Opening a Text File
file = fopen(<filename>, "<MODE>");
```

```
// Do Something if Opening Failed
if (file == NULL) { // Do Something }
```

```
// If Needed: Set Cursor Location
// type = int, float, etc
// offset = # of items to skip
// FLAG
// SEEK_SET = "From Beginning"
// SEEK_CUR = "From Current Location"
// SEEK_END = "From End of File"
fseek(file,
sizeof(<type>) * offset,
FLAG);
```

```
// Read Contents
// dest = Pointer to variable/struct
// type = int, float, etc.
// # = number of values to read
fread(<dest>, sizeof(<type>), <#>, file);
```

```
// Writing Binary Contents
// ptr = Pointer to variable/struct
// type = int, float, etc.
// # = number of values to write
fwrite(<ptr>, sizeof(<type>), <#>, file);
```

```
Close the file
fclose(file);
```

Mode	Meaning
r	Read existing file
w	Write to new file
a	Append to end of file
r+	Read/Write existing file
w+	Read/Write new file
rb	Read existing binary file
wb	Write new binary file
ab	Append to binary file
rb+	Read/Write existing binary
wb+	Read/Write new binary

READING

```
// Read File Contents
char line[100]; // for an entire line
char word[15]; // for a word

do {
// Option 1: Get an entire line
fgets(line, 100, file);

// Option 2: Get individual value(s)
fscanf(file, "%s", word);

} while (!feof(file));
```

WRITING

```
// Writing Text Contents
// Use normal printf formatting
// Values to Print
fprintf(file, "%s", value);
```

Structs are a collection of variables. They are essentially a custom data type.

Struct Type Name (Formal)

```
typedef struct MyCadetInfo_struct {
    char name[50];
    int squad;
    int classYear;
} MyCadetInfo;
```

Struct Variables

Struct Type Name Shortcut

```
// Creating a New Cadet
MyCadetInfo cadet1;
```

```
// Use dots to access the vars inside
strcpy(cadet1.name, "Liam");
cadet1.squad = 19;
cadet1.classYear = 2024;
```

Dynamic Memory — Lessons 24-25

Lets you request memory from the OS.
Requires <stdlib.h>

```
// Step 1: Create a pointer
int* newVar = NULL;

// Step 2: Call malloc()
// Allocates memory for a new var/array
// Size (in bytes)
newVar = (int*)malloc(sizeof(int)*num);
```

NOTES:

- Typecast to match your variable
- Typecast has one more * than sizeof()
- Num = # of values you want to store in your variable
- If you are creating an array, num = array length

```
// Only If Needed: Call realloc()
// Resizes a memory block
// Pointer to Resize Size (in bytes)
newVar = (int*)realloc(newVar, newsize);
```

```
// Step 3: free()
// Returns memory back to the OS
// Every malloc needs a free!
free(newVar);
```

Recursion

Lesson 30-32

Recursion is when a function **calls itself**. It is useful when problems can be broken down into smaller pieces.

Generic Format

Recursive functions consist of 1) base case(s) and 2) recursive case(s)

```
// Ex: Summing up numbers from 1 to n
int summation(int n) {
// Base Case: n == 0
if (n == 0) { ← Base case(s) are the problems
    return 0;    we know the answer to
}

// Recursive Case
return n + summation(n-1);
}
// This is the smaller problem
```

Tail Recursion

This is where we include the current answer in our function call

```
// Same function, but w/tail recursion
int tail_sum(int n, int sumSoFar) {
// Base Case: n == 0
if (n == 0) {
    return sumSoFar; ← We return the
                    accumulated answer
}

// (Tail) Recursive Case
return tail_sum(n-1, n + sumSoFar);
}
// Update sumSoFar
```

Binary Numbers

Lesson 33

```
// This is an integer. Hello integer ☺
int i = 12;

// i is stored as Binary
0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 0000 1100
```

1 1 0 0

$(1 \cdot 2^3) + (1 \cdot 2^2) + (0 \cdot 2^1) + (0 \cdot 2^0) = 12$

```
// You can use 0b to assign i in binary
int i = 0b1100;

// You can use 0x to assign i in hex
int i = 0xC;
```

0=0	1=1	2=2	3=3
4=4	5=5	6=6	7=7
8=8	9=9	10=A	11=B
12=C	13=D	14=E	15=F

Binary Masking

Lesson 34

Using **AND** to extract a specific portion of a larger number

```
1101 1111 0010 0100
& 0000 0000 1111 0000 ← MASK
0000 0000 0010 0000
```

We put 1's where we want to extract. NOTE: We might want to shift the result to read the value.

Binary Flipping

Lesson 34

Using **XOR** to flip specific bits in a larger number

```
1101 1111 0010 0100
^ 0000 1111 1111 0000 ← MASK
1101 0000 1101 0100
```

We put 1's where we want to flip. Everything else stays the same!

Bit Operators

Lesson 33

X	Y	X & Y	X	Y	X Y
0	0	0	0	0	0
0	1	0	0	1	1
1	0	0	1	0	1
1	1	1	1	1	1

X	Y	X ^ Y	X	~X
0	0	0	0	1
0	1	1	1	0
1	0	1		
1	1	0		

Right Shift	0011 >> 2	0000
Left Shift	0011 << 2	1100

Command-Line Arguments

Lesson 35

Command Line Arguments are values that are provided to a program when it is initially executed

To Give CLAs to Your Program

Include arguments in the terminal AFTER your program name. Each word will be an argument (use quotes to group words into a single argument)

```
./a.out argument1 "argument 2"
```

To Access Command-Line Arguments

Modify your main function to include two parameters (below):

```
# Argument(s) Arguments (Stored as Strings)
int main(int argc, char* argv[]) {
// Prints All CLAs
// argv[0] is the program filename
for (int i = 0; i < argc; i++) {
    printf("Arg: %s\n", argv[i]);
}
return 0;
}
```